

Background

ULAB Media Studies and Journalism Department organizes CI each semester focusing on a certain theme that helps students to learn beyond classroom and showcase their creative ideas. For English for media course we made a podcast base on woman empowerment on science. We try to portrait the message maximum exploitation of existing human resources is possible by immediate engagement of women in science. But, historically, scientific field is found to be male-dominated. Women empowerment embraces the good quality education. Sensitizing and encouraging the women towards education embracement enables them to set free from ignorance, poverty and starvation. Hence, education is continuing as the most practicable avenue for women empowerment. Imparting science education to the entire population expedites the accomplishment of scientific and technological progression. The present article enlightens the efforts of the Bangladesh government and the United Nations towards empowerment of women through science education and research. In this podcast we tried to give out the barriers of women in the science field so that our women can overcome these barriers and prove themselves in the right position.

Star Talkies

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Star Talkies

(Podcast Show by Hridoy & Arafat)

Hridoy: Hello there, it's your host Hridoy.

Arafat: And Arafat here, Welcome to our brand-new episode of **Star Talkies**.

Hridoy: So today we will be joined by our two special Guest Walter and Fahim. They are both from ULAB and they are studying in MSJ.

Arafat: Okay so Walter and Fahim, how it's going on guys?

Walter: We are both good, how about you?

Arafat: I am also doing well and actually we feel great to have two of you on the seat of Star Talkies.

Hridoy: So, guys today is 8 march and we all know it's international Women day because of this on this occasion we select a timely topic, yes the topic is our women empowerment in the science field.

Walter: If we see the whole scenario of this field then according to UIS data, less than 30% of the world's researchers are women. UIS data also show the extent to which these women work in the public, private or academic sectors, as well as their fields of research.

Arafat: Yeah, female Education also improves women's own health outcomes and life expectancy, their likelihood of engaging in formal paid employment. How much do you think Bangladeshi women contribute to science in our country?

Fahim: Well, that's not specific, in 2021, there are 90 scientists and engineers in the Bangladesh Atomic Energy Commission and only 16 of them are women. According to the list provided on the website of Bangladesh Rice Research Institute, out of 227 scientists, only 54 are women.

Walter: Although the number was less a few decades ago, but now the number of women scientists is increasing comparatively in this field and people's views change with time.

Hridoy: So, what do you guys think why the increasing rate is too low and what is the main barrier?

Fahim: A student has to spend years studying and learning in order to complete a master's degree. When she cannot pursue a career that is aligned with her education, it becomes a loss of talent as well as resource.

Walter: I want to add that Most of the women drop out from pursuing higher education after or before completing secondary level. There are several causes such as poverty, early marriage, lack of parent's education, insufficient stipend, burden of household chores, lack of security and many others.

Arafat: What is your opinion on this matter, Fahim?

Fahim: The barriers include lack of social security (staying at the lab at night or going on field visits are generally considered unsafe for women), job insecurity (insufficient positions for female science professionals) and overall, an environment that is unfavorable for women and their growth potential.

Walter: Those who came out of all these obstacles are now famous scientists. Some of them are Salma Sultana, Ferdowsi Qadri and Samia Sabrina. We wish them very good luck on behalf of this Show.

Hridoy: I hope this is how our women's society will move forward. Napoleon Said "Give me an educated mother, I shall promise you the birth of a civilized, educated nation."

Arafat: That's all for today, thank you guys for coming.

Hridoy: & Thanks to the audience for watching the show, to support us hit the like button. See you all on another episode.

Ref. Naher,H. Tanim,T. Sultana,N.(2019.07.02) *Women in Science and Technology: A study in Bangladesh*. Retrieved from /www.researchgate.net